

Developing a Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) Policy

GUIDANCE

When developing an SAP for a college program for students with intellectual disability, use these guidelines:

- Begin by reviewing the SAP policy of your IHE. Use this as the foundation for your program's policy. You may follow the IHE policy for minimum GPA required, academic probation and academic dismissal procedures and maximum time frame for program completion.
- One area that your SAP will differ from that of your IHE will be that programs for students with ID include the option to earn credit toward the program's credential by auditing typical college classes. Your SAP should address how progress in audited courses will be measured.
- Additionally, programs for students with ID have additional required learning experiences related to internships and other career development activities, independent living and social growth. The SAP should address how progress in those aspects of the program are tracked as well.

SAP EXAMPLE

Federal regulations require financial aid recipients to maintain "satisfactory academic progress (SAP)" towards the program's recognized certificates and completion requirements. Satisfactory academic progress applies to all students who receive any type of financial assistance administered by the university.

Each required aspect of the program's course of study will be assessed to determine satisfactory progress across all domains. Wherever appropriate, this SAP aligns directly with the policy of the University. See XX (insert a web link to your IHE SAP information). Details below indicate the additions/modifications to the existing SAP policy for our university that apply to students in the CTP program.

University Catalog Coursework

Students who elect coursework for a grade receive points, weighted according to the number of credits in the class. Students who elect coursework on an audit basis receive a grade of AU (successful audit), UAU (unsuccessful audit) or WAU (withdrawal from audit). For the purposes of calculating the cumulative GPA, a grade of AU is awarded 2.0 points and a grade of UAW is awarded zero points; each is weighted according to the number of credits in the class. A grade of WAU does not carry any points and is not included in the GPA unless the student withdraws after the university's standard deadline for withdrawal, in which case the student is given a grade of UAU.

Internship/Work Experience

Students will also participate in the career development component of the program each semester. Satisfactory completion is based on bi-weekly reports from employer/internship site relative to work

behaviors and satisfactory completion of work, report from job coaches or other support personnel, and student self-report. Internships will be graded based on a Pass/Fail system. For the purposes of calculating the cumulative GPA, a grade of Pass is awarded 2.0 points and a grade of Fail is awarded zero points; each internship is weighted the equivalency of 3 credits.

Independent and Community Living

In addition to performance in university catalogue coursework, students are evaluated each semester on the development of independent and community living skills. Students receive a holistic grade of P (pass – progress met or exceeded expectations), F (fail- progress did not meet expectations) or W (withdrawal) in these areas. For the purposes of calculating the cumulative GPA, a grade of Pass is awarded 2.0 points and a grade of F is awarded zero points; each dimension is weighted the equivalency of 3 credits. A grade of W in independent living or community living does not carry any points and is not included in the GPA unless the student withdraws after the university's standard deadline for withdrawal, in which case the student receives a grade of Fail.